

ing for his Hitachi D722 250 GB SATA II hard drive. Needless to say, here's one person who takes system cooling seriously! He also plans to cut a blowhole into the top of his cabinet and add a fan there to control airflow even better.

His Advice

We asked Anindo what advice he'd like to give other technology enthusiasts from around the country.

His response was, "Look, when it comes to hardware and components, it's pretty much what you can afford that decides what you buy. If you have the money to splurge, all you have to do is find a place to buy the latest offerings. Yes, I know even that can be a challenging task at times, but it's simply a question of a little extra time and money. I've found that if you're willing to pay premium, you will always find a dealer that's willing to 'import' things for you—whether from a different city or from abroad.



The 8-megapixel SLR-type Minolta DiMAGE A200 with 7x optical zoom

"The sins I find people committing are with regards to their cabinets, power supplies and, more often than not, absolutely no planning for airflow. Cabinets need to be spacious and airy, and you need to calculate how much power your system will use before buying a power supply.

"Planned airflow is something no one can buy, and you'll have to concentrate on this yourself. Make sure all your wires are out of the way, preferably located high up near the CD/DVD-ROM drive, which doesn't need that much cooling anyway.



An i-mate Pocket PC keeps Anindo connected while on the move

Cabinets need to be spacious and airy, and you need to calculate how much power your system will use. Planned airflow is something no one can "buy" for you.

"I also found that using rounded wires was a lot better for airflow than standard IDE cables. Then there's the need to actually map the airflow in the system and pinpoint how you can get cooled air to flow towards all the components that need it, such as the CPU, graphics card and hard disks. Also remember to make sure that any lighting you put into the cabinet uses as little power as possible and generates minimum heat."

His Plans

People like Anindo are rarely satisfied with the technology they possess. As a result, it's time to go shopping at least once a year for a new system. Being an ATi fan, he wants to buy a CrossFire-ready motherboard in the future, and says that he will stick to Intel processors—as always.

He also mentioned that he would love to try liquid cooling solutions using water and liquid nitrogen as well! "If the current PC is a beast, the next one will be the king of beasts!" avers Anindo.

With better dual core CPUs and multi-CPU boards on the horizon, coupled with dual-graphics card solutions and the availability of the more eccentric RAM-drives to replace primary hard drives, you can see the gleam in Anindo's eyes when he thinks of his next system. His only response to our simple question, "Why?" was a smile and the clichéd one-liner "I have a need, the need for speed!" Clichéd it may have been, but it was a succinct and honest reply...



Unlike most of us Indians, Anindo buys only legal games and software

Whatever the new technology, a handful of enthusiasts will always be ready to buy, even if the performance gains don't merit the increased price. It's people like Anindo, the early adopters of new technology, who drive demand in the market.

It's rare that we come across people as enthusiastic as (or more than) those of us at Digit, and we'll make sure we tell you every time we do. Stay tuned to this space to read any follow-ups on people passionate about technology. If you have done something as crazy, write into us—we'd love to have a chat! ■

robert_smith@thinkdigit.com
nimish_chandiramani@thinkdigit.com



The PC

ASUS P5WD2 Premium motherboard - Rs 17,000
Intel Pentium EE 840 3 Gig (OCd to 3.3) - Rs 15,000
ATi X800 + Cyclone cooler - Rs 28,000
2 GB 667 MHz Transcend RAM - Approx Rs 12,000
Hitachi D722 250 Gig SATA II HDD - Rs 6,000
Asetek Vapochill Micro Extreme - Bought from the UK
UV lasers, light accoutrements - Bought from the UK
Antec Super Lanboy cabinet - Rs 5,500
Antec Truepower 2.0 550 watt power supply - Approx Rs 6000
APC BackUPS RS1000 - Rs 1,000